

# Wednesday, 30 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

## 00 — WEATHER

### Tomorrow's forecast

#### LONDON

Light drizzle

24° 18°

#### BIRMINGHAM

Light rain

21° 16°

#### MANCHESTER

Light rain

21° 15°

#### GLASGOW

Rain

19° 14°

## 01 — NEWS

### Today's top stories

- 1 Prime Minister Andy Burnham has vowed to scrap the existing pension triple lock from 2030, using the savings to help fund social care.**

In an emotional conference speech, Mr Burnham outlined his long-term vision for the UK. The triple lock guarantees state pensions rise by the highest of inflation, average earnings, or 2.5%.

POLITICS · UK

- 2 Manchester City have been found guilty of 'sham' contracts and misleading accounts by the Premier League.**

The club faces severe penalties after being found guilty of all charges related to breaches of financial rules between 2009 and 2018. This is huge news for English football.

SPORT · UK

- 3 Police investigating suspicious vehicles near RAF Fairford found a 'quantity of petrol' but no explosives.**

Five men arrested in connection with the incident have been released on bail. Police describe the decision as "grounded in experience and strategy."

CRIME · UK

- 4 Tragic news as three teenagers have died after their car entered a river.**

The bodies of two teenage boys and a teenage girl were recovered from the water. Police are now investigating the circumstances surrounding the incident.

TRAGEDY · UK

- 5 An initial investigation has found no 'deliberate' contact was made by police to stop a car in a fatal A66 crash.**

This means no stinger device was used by officers before the collision. The investigation continues into the circumstances of the incident.

POLICE · UK

## What's coming up

- 1 **The award-winning police drama 'Blue Lights' is returning, with its new series hitting home for many in Northern Ireland.**  
The show, praised for its realism, explores the tensions between police and communities. It's expected to spark plenty of conversation.  
**ON AIR** – Are you a fan of 'Blue Lights'? What do you think makes it so compelling?  
TV · COMING UP

- 2 **Hollywood actor Michael Sheen believes being an actor will be a disadvantage for him on the upcoming series of 'Celebrity Traitors'.**  
Sheen, a self-confessed big fan of the reality show, is set to try and win the coveted prize. He's known for his intense performances.  
**ON AIR** – Do you think Michael Sheen's acting skills will help or hinder him on 'The Traitors'?  
TV · COMING UP

- 3 **Ahead of Glastonbury 2027 ticket sales, expert advice is being shared to help fans secure their spot.**  
With tickets notoriously difficult to get, tips are emerging on how to avoid common mistakes. It's all about being prepared!  
**ON AIR** – Are you trying to get Glastonbury tickets? What are your top tips for success?  
MUSIC · COMING UP

- 4 **Slipknot fans are reacting to the news that Marilyn Manson will be supporting the heavy metal band at their upcoming UK show.**  
The controversial US rock musician is set to join them for their London performance. It's certainly got people talking.  
**ON AIR** – What do you make of Marilyn Manson supporting Slipknot? Does it change your plans to go?  
MUSIC · COMING UP

- 5 **Amelia Dimoldenberg has announced she will be closing the doors on her hugely popular YouTube series, 'Chicken Shop Date'.**  
After more than a decade, the interviewer known for her deadpan humour is bringing the show to an end. It's been a massive success story.  
**ON AIR** – Are you sad to see 'Chicken Shop Date' end? What were your favourite moments?  
YOUTUBE · COMING UP

## On the schedule

- 1 Manchester City have been found guilty of multiple breaches of Premier League financial rules between 2009 and 2018.**

The club faces significant sanctions after being found guilty of 'sham' contracts and misleading accounts. This is a seismic moment for the Premier League.

**ON AIR** – What do you think the punishment should be for Manchester City? Should they be stripped of titles?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 2 Wayne Rooney says Manchester United do not 'deserve' to be awarded Premier League titles if rivals City are stripped of them.**

His comments come after Manchester City were found guilty of financial breaches. It's a debate that's set to dominate football discussions.

**ON AIR** – Do you agree with Wayne Rooney? Should titles be reallocated if City are found guilty?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 3 Tyson Fury and Anthony Joshua have arrived in London for their news conference, with doubts easing over their December fight.**

The highly anticipated bout is now expected to go ahead as scheduled. Boxing fans will be delighted to hear this news.

**ON AIR** – Are you excited for Fury vs Joshua? Who do you think will win?

BOXING · UK
- 4 England's Cole Palmer is a 'victim' of a 'sick' schedule that expects too much of players, says the PFA chief.**

Maheta Molango, head of the Professional Footballers' Association, expressed concern for player welfare. It's a growing debate in football.

**ON AIR** – Do you think footballers are being asked to play too many games? Is the schedule 'sick'?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 5 Robbie Savage has been offered the manager's job at Peterborough United, with negotiations underway for his exit from Forest Green.**

The former footballer is currently with Forest Green, but could be set for a move. It's an interesting managerial development.

**ON AIR** – Do you think Robbie Savage would be a good fit for Peterborough United?

FOOTBALL · UK

## Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people embracing 'micro-gardening' in their kitchens.**  
Growing small herbs and vegetables on windowsills or countertops is becoming a popular way to bring a touch of green indoors, even in urban flats.
- 2 Research suggests that 'reading a physical book' before bed significantly improves sleep quality.**  
Swapping screens for paper helps the brain wind down, leading to a more restful night and often more vivid dreams.
- 3 The simple act of 'leaving a kind note for a delivery driver' is making people's days brighter.**  
A small message of thanks or a doodle can create a lovely moment of connection and appreciation.
- 4 More people are finding joy in 'exploring their local independent shops'.**  
Discovering unique items and supporting local businesses offers a more personal and rewarding shopping experience than online browsing.
- 5 The delightful hobby of 'collecting unusual teacups and saucers' is on the rise.**  
Each piece often tells a story, and using them for a cuppa can add a touch of everyday elegance to any moment.
- 6 Experts are highlighting the calming effect of 'observing passing trains from a quiet spot'.**  
The rhythmic sounds and movement can be surprisingly meditative, offering a moment of peaceful contemplation.
- 7 A study found that 'wearing mismatched socks on purpose' can boost feelings of individuality and fun.**  
It's a small, quirky way to express yourself and start the day with a smile, proving fashion doesn't always have to be serious.

05 – TALKBACK

## For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

**Q** Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of chocolate, especially if it's a fancy one. What is it?

**ANSWER:** BREAKING OFF A TINY PIECE TO 'TEST' IT, EVEN THOUGH YOU KNOW IT WILL BE DELICIOUS.

**Q** Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of shampoo will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

**ANSWER:** SMELLING THE BOTTLE VERY INTENTLY AND PICTURING HOW LOVELY YOUR HAIR WILL SMELL ALL DAY.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular type of biscuit' just instantly brings back happy memories of childhood tea times or visits to grandparents, even if you haven't had one in years?

What biscuit is it for you, and what lovely memory does it conjure up?

- We all have that 'one small, everyday act of kindness' that, when someone does it for you, truly makes your day, don't we?

What's the simplest act of kindness someone has shown you that just completely brightened your mood?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

**FACT** **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

**FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** Penguins are the only birds that can't fly, but they can run faster than any other flightless bird.

06 – LOTTERY

## Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

**£25 million**

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

**£3.8 million**

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

## Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896; it lasted only 38 minutes.
- The sound of a whip cracking is actually a tiny sonic boom, as the tip moves faster than the speed of sound.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, if conditions are right, due to their unique wing structure.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible even from outer space.
- Carrots were originally purple, yellow, and white, with the orange variety only becoming popular in the 17th century.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The world's quietest room, located at Microsoft's headquarters, is so silent you can hear your own heartbeat.
- It is impossible to hum while holding your nose.

## On this day

Day 273 of the year, 92 days left in 2026. Today Agricultural Reform (Nationalization) Day (São Tomé and Príncipe); Birth of Morelos (Mexico); Blasphemy Day, educates individuals and groups about blasphemy laws and defends freedom of expression; Boy's Day (Poland). Star sign Libra, birthstone Sapphire.

### TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Ian Ogilvy, English-American actor, playwright, and author
- 2002 — Maddie Ziegler, American dancer and actress
- 1960 — Miki Howard, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actress
- 1957 — Fran Drescher, American actress, producer, and screenwriter
- 1966 — Gary Armstrong, Scottish rugby player
- 1977 — Roy Carroll, Northern Irish goalkeeper and manager
- 1978 — Candice Michelle, American wrestler
- 1986 — Ben Lovett, Welsh musician and songwriter

### THE DAY TODAY

- 1945 — The Bourne End rail crash, in Hertfordshire, England, kills 43.
- 1966 — Bechuanaland declares its independence, and becomes the Republic of Botswana.
- 1975 — Malév Flight 240 crashes into the Mediterranean Sea while on approach to Beirut International Airport in Beirut, Lebanon, killing 60.

### TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1944 — World War II: the Germans commence a counter offensive to retake the Nijmegen salient, this having been captured by the allies during Operation Market Garden.
- 1947 — Pakistan joins the United Nations.

### TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1939 — World War II: General Władysław Sikorski becomes prime minister of the Polish government-in-exile.
- 1999 — The Tokaimura nuclear accident causes the deaths of two technicians in Japan's second-worst nuclear accident.

- 1954 — The U.S. Navy submarine USS Nautilus is commissioned as the world's first nuclear-powered vessel.

## A peek at tomorrow

Day 274 of the year, 91 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (South Korea); Beginning of the United States' Fiscal Year; Children's Day (El Salvador, Guatemala, Sri Lanka); Christian feast day: Abai (Syriac Orthodox Church). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

### TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — Cub Koda, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2000)
- 1962 — Paul Walsh, English footballer and sportscaster
- 1980 — Sarah Drew, American actress
- 1939 — Geoffrey Whitehead, English actor
- 1952 — Earl Slick, American rock guitarist and songwriter
- 1986 — Jurnee Smollett, American actress
- 1974 — Keith Duffy, Irish singer-songwriter, dancer, and actor
- 2001 — Luna Blaise, American actress and singer

### THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2022 — One hundred and thirty-five are killed in a human crush following a football match at Kanjuruhan Stadium in East Java, Indonesia.
- 2003 — The popular and controversial English-language imageboard 4chan is launched.
- 2021 — The 2020 World Expo in Dubai begins. Its opening was originally scheduled for 20 October 2020 but was delayed due to the COVID-19 pandemic.

### TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2015 — Heavy rains trigger a major landslide in Guatemala, killing 280 people.
- 1991 — Croatian War of Independence: The Siege of Dubrovnik begins.

# Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16                      **Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller**

FRI 23                      **Frankenstein (del Toro)**

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

## On the sporting calendar